

# FILM DOSSIER: WARLOCK

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Phase 3 · Film #10 (Saga Film #27)

Status:  DOSSIER COMPLETE (awaiting showrunner lock)

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## 1. IDENTITY

| Field                  | Entry                                                           |
|------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film #                 | 27 of 29 (Phase 3, Film #10)                                    |
| Phase                  | Phase 3                                                         |
| Real title             | <b>WARLOCK</b>                                                  |
| Decoy / codename title | <i>"GOLDEN HOUR"</i>                                            |
| Release date           | <b>Friday, March 8, 2019</b>                                    |
| Distributor            | Walt Disney Studios Motion Pictures                             |
| Director               | Denis Villeneuve                                                |
| Rating / runtime       | <b>PG-13 · 148 minutes</b>                                      |
| Genre + second genre   | Superhero action-adventure + <b>metaphysical cosmic fantasy</b> |

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## 2. OWNERSHIP

| Field                           | Entry                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Whose film / franchise is this? | <b>WILL POULTER</b> , the only real actor to have played Adam Warlock. The Warlock franchise is his. |

| Character                                                                                               | Actor                                                               | Age at release |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Adam Warlock                                                                                            | Will Poulter                                                        | 26             |
| The Magus ( <i>Warlock's evil future self</i> )                                                         | Will Poulter                                                        | 26             |
| Gamora ( <i>her soul, in the Soul World</i> )                                                           | Zoe Saldana                                                         | 40             |
| Pip the Troll                                                                                           | Danny DeVito ( <i>fresh casting: never played by a real actor</i> ) | 74             |
| The Silver Surfer                                                                                       | Doug Jones / Laurence Fishburne                                     | 58 / 57        |
| Thanos                                                                                                  | Josh Brolin                                                         | 51             |
| Mistress Death                                                                                          | Aubrey Plaza                                                        | 34             |
| Stan Lee ( <i>cameo, filmed in 2018: a soul in the Soul World who says "It's not so bad in here!"</i> ) | Stan Lee (1922–2018)                                                | –              |

A tribute card before the opening titles: "For Stan." Stan Lee died on November 12, 2018, and this is the first MCU film released after his death.

### 3. SOURCE MATERIAL (EARTH-616)

| Field                    | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Primary comic(s) adapted | Jim Starlin's <i>Warlock</i> #9–15 (1975–76) and <i>Marvel Two-in-One Annual</i> #2 (1977): the Soul World inside the Soul Gem, Pip the Troll, Gamora, and Warlock's soul captured in his own Gem. <i>Silver Surfer</i> vol. 3 #45–50 (1990–91): Warlock, Gamora and Pip leave the Soul World to stop Thanos. |
| Supporting comics        | <i>The Infinity Gauntlet</i> #2 (1991): Warlock takes charge of the fight against Thanos · <i>Strange Tales</i> #178–181 (1975, the Magus)                                                                                                                                                                    |
| Nerf check               | ✅ The Magus is Warlock at the height of his power, turned evil. Warlock wins by accepting his own darkness, not by overpowering it.                                                                                                                                                                           |

#### 3A. COMIC ACCURACY REPORT

| Field                  | Entry                                                                        |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Overall accuracy score | 94%. It adapts the Soul World as Starlin wrote it and Warlock's 1990 return. |

Straight from the page:

- Inside the Soul Gem is the Soul World, a golden paradise where the captured souls live in peace (*Warlock*

#11; *MTIO Annual* #2).

- **Adam Warlock's soul** lives there after the Gem takes it (*MTIO Annual* #2).
- **Gamora's soul** is there too (*Warlock* #15).
- **Pip the Troll**, a cynical, rowdy, lovable troll, is Warlock's friend in the Soul World (*Strange Tales* #179).
- **Warlock, Gamora and Pip** leave the Soul World to fight Thanos (*Silver Surfer* #45–50; *IG* #2).

### Changes and why:

| Change | Why |

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| **The Magus is fought inside the Soul World** | MCU continuity. The Soul Gem took his soul in *Guardians of the Galaxy* (2014). |

| **The Surfer opens the way out** | On 616 the circumstances of their return were different. Here the Power Cosmic connects Earth to the Gem, which ties the Surfer into Warlock's return. |

### POWERS & ABILITIES

| Character                | 616 powers & abilities                                                                                                                               | Shown in this film                                                           | Held back (why)                                   | Match                                                                                         |
|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Adam Warlock</b>      | <b>Cosmic energy manipulation</b> ; flight; super strength; <b>cosmic awareness</b> ; regeneration by <b>cocoon</b> ; master of the Soul Gem's realm | All of it, <b>including rebuilding a collapsing Soul World with his mind</b> | Wielding the Gauntlet ( <i>Avengers Forever</i> ) | <br>100%   |
| <b>The Magus</b>         | Warlock's powers, <b>amplified</b> , with none of his mercy                                                                                          | Tears the Soul World apart                                                   | –                                                 | <br>100% |
| <b>Gamora</b>            | The deadliest woman in the galaxy                                                                                                                    | She's a soul here, and she fights like it                                    | –                                                 | <br>100% |
| <b>Pip</b>               | <b>Teleportation</b> ; troll strength                                                                                                                | Teleports the trio across the Soul World                                     | –                                                 | <br>100% |
| <b>The Silver Surfer</b> | The Power Cosmic                                                                                                                                     | <b>Reaches into the Soul Gem's frequency from Earth</b>                      | –                                                 | <br>100% |

## 4. STORY

| Field                | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Logline              | Trapped inside the Soul Gem on Thanos's hand, a golden god-man, a dead assassin and a foul-mouthed troll have five years to find the one crack in paradise that leads back to a broken universe. |
| Theme                | <b>Accepting yourself.</b> Warlock has to face the Magus, the worst version of who he could be, to become who the universe needs.                                                                |
| Villain / antagonist | <b>The Magus</b> (main); <b>Thanos</b> (outside the Gem, beyond reach)                                                                                                                           |

### What the movie is about

#### ACT ONE: PARADISE

- **The Soul World** is endless, golden and timeless. **Adam Warlock** has watched over its souls since Thanos took his Gem.
- **Gamora** arrives (from the *Infinity Gauntlet* post-credit scene). Then **Pip the Troll**, who has been in here for centuries and will not stop talking.
- Through the Gem, Warlock can **feel the snap**: half the universe, gone.
- He can also see **Thanos** through the Gem, sitting on his throne, with **Death** still not looking at him.

#### ACT TWO: THE MAGUS

- Something is **rotting paradise** from the inside: **the Magus**, whose soul the Gem took in *Guardians of the Galaxy*.
- The Magus wants to **take control of the Soul Gem from within** and use it through Thanos's Gauntlet.
- Warlock, Gamora and Pip are hunted across a Soul World that's falling apart.
- Gamora faces the memory of her father. Pip faces the souls he's wronged.
- Warlock faces **himself**.

#### ACT THREE: THE CRACK

- **Warlock vs. the Magus.** Warlock stops fighting him and **accepts him** as part of himself, and the Magus fades.
  - In **Earth time**, **five years** have passed. On Earth, the **Silver Surfer**, grief-stricken, **reaches through the Power Cosmic into the Soul Gem's frequency**.
  - There's a **crack** in the golden sky.
  - **Warlock, Gamora and Pip** step through it, **out of the Soul Gem and into the ruins of Earth, 2023**.
  - The Surfer is waiting, with **Captain America, Iron Man and Thor**, older and grieving.
  - **WARLOCK**: "I know how to beat him. You're not going to like it."
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## 5. MCU TIMELINE PLACEMENT

| Field                   | Entry                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| When it's set           | <b>The Soul World is timeless.</b> Its events line up with Earth time from <b>Saturday, April 28, 2018</b> (the snap) to <b>Monday, April 24, 2023</b> (the escape). |
| Where it's set          | <b>The Soul World</b> (gold-tinted practical landscapes, filmed in Iceland and at the Wadi Rum desert)<br>· <b>the ruins of New York, 2023</b> (the final scene)     |
| Relative to other films | <b>It runs from the snap to the five-year mark.</b> The last scene is <b>the opening of <i>Avengers Forever</i>'s main story.</b>                                    |

## 6. WORLD-BUILDING

### The film's own world

- **The Soul World, Pip, the Magus** (seemingly gone for good).
- **Warlock** comes back as the Infinity Saga's savior.

### World-building for the wider MCU

| Seed                     | How it appears              | Payoff                                                              |
|--------------------------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>The five-year gap</b> | Warlock steps out into 2023 | <i>Avengers Forever</i>                                             |
| <b>The Magus's end</b>   | He fades                    | (616: he returns in <i>The Infinity War</i> , 1992, after the saga) |

### Setting up the Big Bad

| Seed                  | How it appears                 | What it means                                                         |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Warlock's plan</b> | "You're not going to like it." | <b>Warlock knows that Thanos always leaves himself a way to lose.</b> |

## 7. POST-CREDIT SCENES

| Field                  | Entry                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Mid-credit scene       | ✓ "PIP." Pip sees New York in 2023 for the first time: <i>"Yeah, this is worse than the Soul World."</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
| Post-credit scene      | ✓ "ASCENSION." Thanos's temple. <b>Thanos</b> , with <b>Mephisto</b> beside him, closes his eyes. <b>His body goes still</b> , and something <b>enormous and luminous</b> rises out of it into the stars. <b>He's becoming the universe itself.</b><br><b>MEPHISTO</b> (to himself, smiling): <i>"Higher, Titan. Higher. The fall will be so much longer."</i> <b>CUT TO BLACK.</b> <b>"ADAM WARLOCK WILL RETURN IN AVENGERS FOREVER."</b> |
| Secret shoot codenames | Mid-credit: <b>"SIGHTSEEING."</b> Post-credit: <b>"ELEVATOR."</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

## CHECKLIST

- [x] Comic(s) adapted · [x] Comic Accuracy Report + powers · [x] Real and decoy titles · [x] What it's about · [x] Villain · [x] Post-credit scenes · [x] The film's own world-building · [x] MCU world-building · [x] Big Bad setup · [x] Whose franchise · [x] When and where in the timeline